

Sleekr: Turning to Google Cloud for back- office software for thousands of businesses

Tell us your challenge. We're here to help.

[Contact us \(/contact\)](#)

ABOUT SLEEKR

Using Google Cloud, Sleekr has reduced cost and deployment time, enabling customers to realize their vision of growing, becoming more efficient, and competing effectively.



About Sleekr

Founded in 2015, Sleekr provides integrated payroll, human resources, and accounting software for businesses in Indonesia.

Thousands of businesses with a combined total of approximately 100,000 employees use Sleekr solutions.

Industries: Technology

Location: Indonesia

Google Cloud results

- Enables delivery of cloud-based software to thousands of businesses
- Supports business goal of enabling customers to grow, operate more efficiently, and be more competitive
- Helps reduce costs by 30% and deployment times 80% compared to previous cloud environment

Cut time to market
50% to two er

Kubernetes Engine

(<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>)

Compute Engine

(<https://cloud.google.com/compute/>)

(<https://cloud.google.com/memorystore/>)

Cloud SQL (<https://cloud.google.com/sql/>)

Cloud Load Balancing

(<https://cloud.google.com/load-balancing/>)

reins your challenge. We're here to help.

Container Registry

(<https://cloud.google.com/container-registry/>)

Cloud Storage (<https://cloud.google.com/storage/>)

Cloud Memorystore

(<https://cloud.google.com/memorystore/>)

Cloud software is spreading from IT teams at businesses in Indonesia to operations, human resources, finance, and other back-office departments, according to cloud-based applications provider **Sleekr** (<https://sleekr.co/>). Managers and workers in these departments increasingly invest in cloud software to transform back-office processes and capabilities.

“For example, the need to deliver compulsory employee benefits and make remuneration packages attractive to talented people is increasing the complexity of payroll systems,” explains Rafeequl Rahman, Chief Technology Officer, Sleekr. “Using cumbersome spreadsheets to manage these and other corporate functions is no longer an option. Businesses want an efficient and effective solution, and this is where Sleekr fits in.”

Founded in 2015, Sleekr provides integrated payroll, human resources, and accounting software for businesses in Indonesia. Originally founded to market a simple employee database, Sleekr now helps customers use technology to create more effective workplaces. Thousands of businesses with a combined total of approximately 100,000 employees use Sleekr solutions.

Rahman is responsible for developing and running Sleekr’s software. “I make sure we are constantly delivering value to our customers and making our daily operations smooth,” he says. The business started by using virtual machines in a hosted cloud environment. However, its information technology and engineering team was having to dedicate more

than 50 percent of its time on managing routine tasks, such as configuring clusters and performing updates and backups, that had no direct impact on business success. Furthermore, the team saw an opportunity to dramatically reduce software deployment times.

“We wanted to control our costs and allocate team members and resources to tasks that delivered value rather than simply kept the lights on,” says Rahman. “We effectively wanted to hand our infrastructure over to an experienced cloud provider with intelligent managed services. In addition, we had to align our infrastructure investments with our business growth.”

“As the best
Kubernetes
offering on the
market, the
offering from
Google heavily
influenced our
decision. Our
evaluation also
spanned cost
and the full suite
of products and

managed
services
available from
each provider.
Google Cloud
was easily the
best fit for our
business.”

*—Rafeequl Rahman, Chief
Technology Officer, Sleekr*

Faster time to market

Sleekr’s requirements went beyond increased efficiency. The business wanted to capitalize on new-generation cloud products to minimize time to market, improving the customer experience.

After considering its technical requirements, Sleekr decided to adopt a containerized solution. The business wanted to develop and iterate applications quickly with underlying cloud resources provisioned and managed automatically. “As the best Kubernetes offering on the market, the offering from Google heavily influenced our decision,” says Rahman. “Our evaluation also spanned cost and the full suite of products and managed services available from each provider. Google Cloud was easily the best fit for our business.”

Sleekr now runs a Google Cloud environment comprising Kubernetes Engine (<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>); Compute Engine (<https://cloud.google.com/compute/>) to provide infrastructure as a service running on Google infrastructure; Cloud SQL (<https://cloud.google.com/sql/>) to run its relational database; Cloud Load Balancing (<https://cloud.google.com/load-balancing/>) to provide cross-region load balancing including automated failover; Container Registry (<https://cloud.google.com/container-registry/>) to store its private Docker images on Google Cloud; Cloud Memorystore (<https://cloud.google.com/memorystore/>) to provide a fully managed in-memory data store; and Cloud Storage (<https://cloud.google.com/storage/>) to deliver unified object storage.

“With Google
Cloud, we can
explore
possibilities
such as having
product
managers rather
than system
administrators
deliver releases

more securely to
production, and
our business
teams creating
charts or reports
rather than
asking our
developers to
provide metrics.”

*—Rafeequl Rahman, Chief
Technology Officer, Sleekr*

A continuous integration and development platform

Kubernetes Engine has given Sleekr a continuous integration and continuous development platform that enables the business to respond more effectively to customer needs.

Using Google Cloud has enabled Sleekr to democratize access to information technology. This helps avoid the strict segregation of duties that can shunt systems and data into silos accessible only to selected teams. “For example, with Google Cloud, we can explore possibilities such as having product managers rather than system administrators deliver releases more securely to production, and our business teams creating charts or reports rather

than asking our developers to provide metrics,” says Rahman.

Sleekr has collaborated with a small software house to create an open source tool that enables the business to use Kubernetes Engine as an on-demand staging host. “We work in a high-paced environment, where new features are delivered to production as soon as they pass technical tests and signoff from product owners,” says Rahman. “With Kubernetes Engine, we can deploy several isolated staging environments at once to help ensure there are no delays when we have multiple tasks or features ready to go.”

This approach, powered by Kubernetes, has enabled Sleekr to improve the elasticity and scalability of its environment and reduce deployment times from once a week to several times a day.

More broadly, Google Cloud has enabled Sleekr’s information technology and engineering team to translate the chief executive officer’s vision into actionable goals. “Everything we do needs to be driven by or provide value to the business,” explains Rahman. “This ranges from developing new features to optimize our underlying platform to delivering operational cost savings.”

Adopting managed services through Google Cloud has enabled Sleekr to record savings of more than 30 percent compared to its previous cloud-hosting service, excluding the cost of team members to manage the infrastructure.

“Our focus is on eliminating waste and removing roadblocks rather than cost reduction per se,” says Rahman. “We believe cost reduction is a byproduct of process efficiency.”

Furthermore, despite its increased production activity, Sleekr still only requires two team members to manage infrastructure-related tasks such as operations, maintenance, upgrades, and automation.

“Ultimately, we
define success
by how our
customers grow
and deliver value
to our nation.
Google enables
us to realize
these goals.”

*—Rafeequl Rahman, Chief
Technology Officer, Sleekr*

Deployment five times faster

Furthermore, the time needed for the information technology and engineering team to complete

routine tasks has fallen to just 10 percent, instead of the 50 percent of their time they previously spent on these activities. This gives customers faster access to better experiences.

“Success is, for us, seeing our customers operate more efficiently, be more competitive, and provide a meaningful, positive impact on their employees and stakeholders,” says Rahman. “Ultimately, we define success by how our customers grow and deliver value to our nation. Google enables us to realize these goals.”